

S04-02 - The Hanging Office Exterior

Player read-aloud

A cabin-sized boulder rests below the tree, tied by thick rope to a hanging office above. It blinks with inspection seals and an old warning light.

Scene summary

The Custodian's suspended treehouse-office hangs from an ancient tree.

Visible choices

- Call up
- Climb
- Tamper with counterweight
- Use magic

Player questions

- What detail in The Hanging Office Exterior tells you the official story is incomplete?
- Who notices the human cost first, and how do they show it?
- What small object, smell, or sound makes this scene feel real?

Raw source

- Id: S04-02
- Act: Act Four
- Title: The Hanging Office Exterior
- Beats: Location focus Roll/check Corporate satire beat
- Image: assets/scenes/S04-02-the-hanging-office-exterior.png
- Short: The Custodian's suspended treehouse-office hangs from an ancient tree.
- Long: This is a problem-solving scene and a visual thesis: bureaucracy has literally been hung from a living forest.
- Read: A cabin-sized boulder rests below the tree, tied by thick rope to a hanging office above. It blinks with inspection seals and an old warning light.
- Gm: Let them solve how to get attention. The tree gently stops reckless climbing.
- Entities: The Hanging Office Whitefire Custodian Inspection-Sealed Counterweight Barnacle Garrick Reed Emeris Clerk
- Choices: Call up Climb Tamper with counterweight Use magic
- Prompt: Strange hanging treehouse-office suspended from ancient tree by ropes and pulleys, huge rune-marked counterweight boulder, inspection seals, dangling forms; adventurers stand below; no strixwolf, no undead.
- Source Entities: The Hanging Office Whitefire Custodian Inspection-Sealed Counterweight
- Beat Codes: location-focus roll-check corporate-satire-beat
- Slug: S04-02-the-hanging-office-exterior

- Act Title: The Hanging Office
- Arc Role: Mentor-custodian truth reveal
- Caption: The Hanging Office is absurd because the system is absurd; the people inside are not.
- Image Alt: The Hanging Office Exterior scene art for The Hanging Office.
- Image Prompt Used: Strange hanging treehouse-office suspended from ancient tree by ropes and pulleys, huge rune-marked counterweight boulder, inspection seals, dangling forms; adventurers stand below; no strixwolf, no undead. Do not include the Strixwolf Mother, strixwolf pups, wolves, owlbeats, or animal companions unless explicitly requested. No strixwolf, no Bramble Union, no undead. Focus on the Custodian and the Keystone Asset reveal. 4:3 cinematic fantasy concept art, no visible text, no captions, no logos, no UI, no watermark.
- Long Storyboard: This is a problem-solving scene and a visual thesis: bureaucracy has literally been hung from a living forest. Run this scene as mentor-custodian truth reveal: The Hanging Office is absurd because the system is absurd; the people inside are not. Keep the camera close to practical choices, visible consequences, and the difference between ordinary people and the infrastructure pressing on them.
- Read Aloud: A cabin-sized boulder rests below the tree, tied by thick rope to a hanging office above. It blinks with inspection seals and an old warning light.
- Gm Notes: Let them solve how to get attention. The tree gently stops reckless climbing. Keep player-facing information actionable. Reveal systemic truth through objects, reactions, and consequences before naming it. Manufactured-threat lens: seed the contradiction, do not explain it. The surface goal stays simple and heroic.
- Sensory Details: rope creak ink and leaf mold stamped denial letters fluttering in warm wind
- Body Language: Barnacle checks every ladder twice Garrick takes the unsafe side without announcing it
- Sample Dialogue: Office clerk note Please hold your emergency until your emergency can be categorized.
- Checks: Agility Navigate the suspended office safely. Easy to standard Avoid losing time or dignity. 10/15 Cleanly resolve: Navigate the suspended office safely. Add a concrete boon, extra clue, or improved position. Success, plus the player names one helpful detail or asks one follow-up question. Success, but the GM exposes a cost, ticks a countdown, or reveals a new pressure tied to The Hanging Office Exterior. The full goal slips, but the party still learns a useful truth or avoids the worst consequence. The GM makes a hard move that follows from the fiction and leaves the next choice visible. Spend Fear to expose neglected infrastructure, stress the Custodian, or make the Keystone hum at the wrong moment. On mixed or sliding results, reveal information in layers: visible fact, actionable clue, then systemic truth. Knowledge Read the office backlog. Standard Expose infrastructure neglect. 15 Cleanly resolve: Read the office backlog. Add a concrete boon, extra clue, or improved position. Success, plus the player names one helpful detail or asks one follow-up question. Success, but the GM exposes a cost, ticks a countdown, or reveals a new pressure tied to The Hanging Office Exterior...
- Choices Consequences: Respect the office's precariousness The Custodian sees care before competence. Custodian Trust possible. Mock the place loudly The joke lands on the wrong target. Custodian starts colder.
- Clues: Inspection-Sealed Counterweight The office is unsafe. Corporate oversight

records risk but does not fix it. The office itself is under audit, yet still doing the work.

- Loot: Use Hanging Office search results table
- Payoff Flags: Custodian Trust Track
- Filters: act-four choice corporate-satire-beat custodian-trust-track gm-only location-focus rollcheck the-hanging-office npc manufactured-threat guaranteed-earned
- Index: 14
- Player Questions: What detail in The Hanging Office Exterior tells you the official story is incomplete? Who notices the human cost first, and how do they show it? What small object, smell, or sound makes this scene feel real?
- Relationship Prompts: Which PC quietly checks on someone else here? Who disagrees about the right thing to do without breaking trust?
- Ownership Prompt: Name one detail in The Hanging Office Exterior that belongs to your character's point of view.
- Reveal Hooks: Loreborne or Knowledge-focused PCs can read the institutional layer. Wildborne/community-focused PCs can read local custom and ecological stress. Martial/security-focused PCs can read threat posture and custody logic. Magic-focused PCs can feel ward tone, soul-signal, or spell instability. Loreborne: spots older legal, heraldic, or ward-craft language under the branding. Underborne: notices service doors, hidden routes, and who built the thing nobody credits. Highborne: reads etiquette, class panic, and reputational risk. Ridgeborne: notices stonework, weight, pressure, and structural weakness. Wildborne: reads the land, animals, and local ecological stress. Elf/Ribbet/Human/Giant/Katari: invite one sensory or social detail from the player's heritage. Sorcerer/Rogue/Warrior/Guardian/Ranger: give each class one table-facing way to shine without changing the plot.
- Fear Spends: Spend Fear to expose neglected infrastructure, stress the Custodian, or make the Keystone hum at the wrong moment. Make neglected infrastructure answer at the wrong moment. Stress the Custodian's trust without turning her into a device.
- Story Scope: Perceived antagonist: the forest. True antagonist: the corporate lie about the forest. The players never confront it directly. They are meant to feel it by the end. Every act offers at least one guaranteed and one earned hint that the danger is manufactured and the forest is not the enemy. The sealed package is the capital's ward Keystone; the city is unwarded while it is away. KEEP GUARANTEED "The wood never needed managing. It needed leaving alone." ADD SEED "Your capital's safety is older than your contracts. It is the very thing they teach you to fear." ADD SEED The Keystone's magic is pre-corporate forest-ward work, the same school companies call primitive. ADD EARNED Knowledge Hard 20 The Custodian glances at obsolete Soulspire inspection seals on her counterweight boulder. ADD EARNED Instinct Medium 15 Presence: earn candor. Knowledge: place the magic. Instinct: read the Custodian's fear. ACT4 Act 4: Hanging Office 160 2:05 to 2:40 2:40 Custodian, Keystone reveal, new objective, short rest Compress the reveal; bank the Short Rest into travel narration.
- Mechanics: The party is in Act Four pressure: The Custodian's suspended treehouse-office hangs from an ancient tree. Use Daggerheart Duality Dice as baseline. Use the listed Difficulty and outcome options when a roll matters. Keep trivial actions no-roll; roll only when uncertainty, cost, or danger is interesting. s04-02-reach-the-

hanging-office S04-02 Reach the Hanging Office Reach the Hanging Office Agility Strength Agility Strength 13 Agility climbs; Strength holds rope, ladder, or counterweight. The approach turns comic, hazardous, or disrespectful. Critical Success: best possible version of the action; gain Hope and clear 1 Stress. Add an extra benefit that follows from the fiction. Success with Hope: the PC gets what they wanted and gains Hope. Keep the position clean or generous. Success with Fear: the PC gets what they wanted, but the GM gains Fear and introduces a cost, complication, or pressure. Failure with Hope: the PC does not get the full result, but gains Hope and receives a useful thread, clue, or safer next option. Failure with Fear: the PC fails and the GM gains Fear. Make a hard move that follows from the fiction. The approach turns comic, hazardous, or disrespectful. Use...

- Roll Cards: s04-02-reach-the-hanging-office S04-02 Reach the Hanging Office Reach the Hanging Office Agility Strength Agility Strength 13 Agility climbs; Strength holds rope, ladder, or counterweight. The approach turns comic, hazardous, or disrespectful. Critical Success: best possible version of the action; gain Hope and clear 1 Stress. Add an extra benefit that follows from the fiction. Success with Hope: the PC gets what they wanted and gains Hope. Keep the position clean or generous. Success with Fear: the PC gets what they wanted, but the GM gains Fear and introduces a cost, complication, or pressure. Failure with Hope: the PC does not get the full result, but gains Hope and receives a useful thread, clue, or safer next option. Failure with Fear: the PC fails and the GM gains Fear. Make a hard move that follows from the fiction. The approach turns comic, hazardous, or disrespectful. Use a hard complication, lost time, worse position, GM Fear, or mark Stress. Apply an official condition only if the fiction and rules justify it. The attempt falls short, but a partial thread appears. Offer one clue, weak position, or safer follow-up. The PC gets the core result, but it costs time...
- Conditions Hazards: Restrained
- Search Loot Clues: No fixed loot. Offer clue, texture, or hospitality only when the fiction supports it.
- No Roll Guidance: Do not call for a roll when the players have time, a clear method, and no meaningful pressure.
- Tv Mechanics Caption: Public cue: The Hanging Office Exterior asks what the party does, what it costs, and who is protected.
- Trait Variety Note: Primary traits in this scene: Agility, Finesse, Knowledge, Strength. If rolls drift toward Instinct/Presence, ask whether Agility, Strength, Finesse, or Knowledge better describes the action.
- Location Ids: the-hanging-office
- Image Asset Status: image_gen

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